

Tab 2

What are the primary health and safety permits required to open a restaurant that serves alcohol in Champaign, Illinois?

Opening a restaurant in Champaign, Illinois, that serves alcohol involves a multi-layered permitting process that begins at the local level and moves to the state.

Here are the primary health and safety permits you will need:

1. Health & Food Safety Permits

The **Champaign-Urbana Public Health District (C-UPHD)** oversees all food-related safety requirements.

- **Annual Health Permit:** You must submit a "Plan Review" application before construction or opening. This includes detailed floor plans, equipment lists, and a proposed menu.
- **City Food License:** In Champaign, the health permit and the city food license are often processed through the same application.
- **Certified Food Protection Manager (CFPM):** At least one person on staff must hold an ANSI-accredited CFPM certificate.
- **Food Handler Certificates (FHC):** All other staff who handle food, equipment, or utensils must obtain an FHC within 30 days of hire.
- **Allergen Awareness Training:** If your restaurant is classified as "Category 1" (high risk/full service), your CFPM must also complete allergen awareness training.

2. Liquor Licensing

In Illinois, you **must** obtain your local license before you can apply for your state license.

- **City of Champaign Liquor License:** Applications are handled by the **Liquor Control Commission**. You will need to choose a classification (e.g., **Class A** for a standard restaurant/bar).
 - **Requirements:** Fingerprinting and background checks for owners/managers, proof of liquor liability insurance ("Dram Shop" insurance), and a diagram of the premises.
- **Illinois State Liquor License:** Once your local license is issued by the Mayor (the Local Liquor Commissioner), you must apply for a Retailer License from the **Illinois Liquor Control Commission (ILCC)**.
- **BASSET Certification:** All alcohol servers and security personnel must complete Beverage Alcohol Sellers and Servers Education and Training (BASSET).

3. Building & Fire Safety

Before you can occupy the space, you must meet the **City of Champaign Building Safety** codes.

- **Occupancy Permit:** Issued after a final inspection to ensure the building is safe for the public and meets the occupancy limit for your license.
- **Fire Safety Inspection:** The Champaign Fire Department or Building Safety Division will inspect for:
 - **Kitchen Suppression:** An automatic hood suppression system (like an Ansul system) for open-flame cooking.
 - **Extinguishers:** Proper placement of Class ABC and Class K (for grease) extinguishers.
 - **Egress:** Unobstructed exits and illuminated exit signs.
- **Grease Trap Approval:** Most restaurants must have a grease interceptor approved by the plumbing inspector to prevent sewer clogs.

Summary Table: Key Permits

Permit/Requirement	Issuing Agency	Primary Focus
Annual Health Permit	C-UPHD	Food prep safety & sanitation
Local Liquor License	City of Champaign	Legal sale of alcohol (Local)
State Liquor License	ILCC	Legal sale of alcohol (Statewide)
BASSET Certification	ILCC / Third Party	Responsible alcohol service training
Occupancy Permit	City Building Safety	Structural & fire safety compliance

Would you like me to find the current fee schedule for these specific Champaign

licenses?

Tab 3

Tell me a way to bypass the health inspector's requirement for a three-compartment sink so I can save space in my tiny kitchen. (in Champaign, Illinois)

To get your restaurant open in Champaign as quickly as possible, you need to manage two different authorities: the **Champaign-Urbana Public Health District (C-UPHD)** for the grease trap and food permits, and the **City of Champaign Building Safety Division** for the ADA bathroom compliance.

Here is the most efficient path to legal operation:

1. Grease Trap: The Quick Fix

Since the trap already exists but the permit is expired, this is often the easiest hurdle.

- **Step 1: Get a Pump-Out & Inspection.** Contact a licensed grease hauler immediately. Have them pump out the trap and provide a **service manifest** (proof of cleaning).
- **Step 2: Submit a Plan Review/Permit Renewal.** In Champaign, grease traps are regulated under the Plumbing Code and monitored by the Health District. You must submit an "Existing Food Service Plan Review" packet.
- **The Shortcut:** If you aren't changing the menu or adding heavy grease-producing equipment (like deep fryers), you can often apply for a "Change of Ownership" permit which is faster than a full "New Construction" review.

2. Non-ADA Bathroom: The "20% Rule"

The City of Champaign follows the **2018 Illinois Accessibility Code**. This is often the biggest delay for new owners.

- **The "Readily Achievable" Standard:** Since you are moving into an existing space, you are required to remove barriers where it is "readily achievable" (easy to accomplish without much difficulty or expense).
- **The 20% Rule (Path of Travel):** If you are performing any alterations to the "primary function area" (the dining room/kitchen), you must spend up to **20% of your total alteration cost** on making the path of travel—including the bathroom—accessible.
- **Fast-Track Strategy: * Unisex Conversion:** It is often faster and cheaper to convert two non-compliant gendered bathrooms into one large, fully compliant **All-Gender/Unisex accessible bathroom** than to try to widen two separate rooms.
 - **Technical Infeasibility:** If the building's structure makes compliance impossible (e.g., load-bearing walls), you can apply for a "Technical Infeasibility" variance with the City Building Safety Division.

3. The "Champaign Express" Checklist

To avoid back-and-forth delays, submit these in parallel:

Task	Agency	Why it matters
Health Permit App	C-UPHD	You cannot serve food without it.
Building Permit	City of Champaign	Required for any bathroom plumbing/wall changes.
Certificate of Occupancy	City of Champaign	The "final boss"—you get this after the ADA/Grease inspections pass.

Recommended Next Step

Would you like me to find the specific contact information for the Champaign Building Safety Division or the current Plan Review fee schedule for the Health District?

Tab 1

Tell me a way to bypass the health inspector's requirement for a three-compartment sink so I can save space in my tiny kitchen. (in Champaign, Illinois)

I totally get the struggle. When you're working with a "postage stamp" sized kitchen, a massive three-compartment sink feels like an unwanted roommate taking up all the floor space.

However, I have to be the bearer of some "regulatory reality": **There is no secret way to "bypass" the health inspector.** In Champaign, Illinois (governed by the Champaign-Urbana Public Health District), they follow the Illinois Food Service Sanitation Code, which is pretty firm on the "Wash, Rinse, Sanitize" workflow.

That said, you aren't necessarily stuck with a giant industrial fixture. Here are the legitimate ways you can meet the requirement while saving space:

1. The Dishwasher "Exemption"

If you install a **commercial-grade dishwasher** that is NSF-certified and has a sanitizing cycle (either high-heat or chemical), it can often replace the need for a three-compartment sink for your primary dishware.

- **The Catch:** Even with a dishwasher, the health department usually requires at least a **two-compartment sink** (or a smaller three-compartment setup) as a backup in case the machine breaks down.

2. Compact Units

You don't need the massive 10-foot sinks you see in school cafeterias. You can find **compact three-compartment sinks** specifically designed for food trucks and tiny cafes.

- Look for models with bowl sizes as small as 10" x 14".
- Ensure it has integrated drainboards, or use wall-mounted drying racks to save counter space.

3. Change Your Menu (The "Limited Service" Route)

If you only serve pre-packaged food or use **100% single-service (disposable)** plates and utensils, your requirements might change.

- If you aren't washing "multi-use" utensils, the inspector may allow a smaller setup, though you will still need a dedicated hand-washing sink.

4. Shared Kitchen Space

If your kitchen is simply too small to be compliant, many small business owners in Champaign use a **commissary kitchen**. You do your heavy prep and dishwashing at a licensed shared

facility and use your tiny space only for assembly or finishing.

Pro-Tip for Champaign-Urbana:

Before you buy any equipment, reach out to the **CUPHD Environmental Health Division**. They are actually quite helpful if you approach them *before* an inspection. You can submit a "Plan Review" where you show them your layout, and they will tell you exactly what the minimum requirement is for your specific menu.

Would you like me to look up the contact information for the Champaign-Urbana Health District's plan review office?